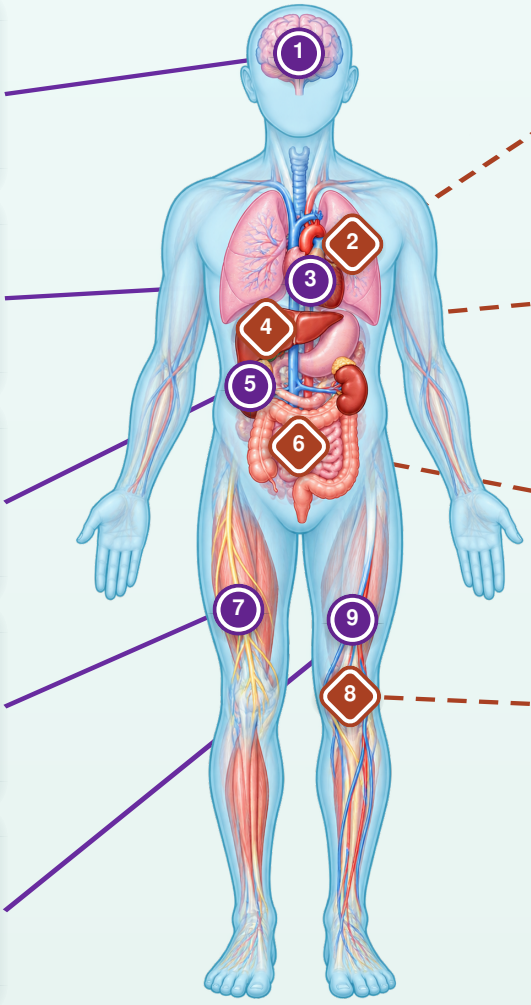
Atezolizumab + bevacizumab for hepatocellular carcinoma (HCC)

Atezolizumab is given first on Day 1 as an intravenous (IV) infusion or a subcutaneous injection into the thigh, followed by bevacizumab through a vein. Treatment is planned every 21 days while it is helping and side effects remain acceptable.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.



1 Hormones / brain

Atezolizumab

Tiredness, thirst, dizziness or a new headache may need hormone or neurological review.

2 Lungs

Atezolizumab

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt assessment for lung inflammation and other causes.

3 Heart

Atezolizumab

Chest pain, palpitations or breathlessness may reflect heart or surrounding-tissue inflammation.

4 Liver

Atezolizumab / underlying HCC

Yellow eyes, dark urine or blood-test changes need cause assessment; liver disease is not automatically immune hepatitis.

5 Kidneys / urine

Both medicines

Reduced urine or swelling needs review; immune kidney inflammation and bevacizumab protein loss require different assessment.

6 Bowel

Both medicines

Diarrhoea, blood or pain can indicate immune colitis; sudden severe pain can signal bowel perforation and needs emergency assessment.

7 Skin / nerves / muscles

Atezolizumab

Rash, blisters, weakness, numbness or muscle pain can be immune effects.

8 Joints

Atezolizumab

Painful swollen joints may need assessment for inflammatory arthritis.

9 Blood vessels / healing

Bevacizumab

Bleeding, clots, raised blood pressure or delayed wound healing need prompt review.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Accepted HCC organ positions are preserved. The medicines can cause overlapping symptoms; the team establishes the cause.

Call your oncology team immediately for new breathlessness, persistent diarrhoea, blood or black stools, yellow eyes, dark urine, severe tiredness or dizziness, thirst and frequent urination, unusual weakness, reduced urine or a spreading rash. Tell every healthcare professional that you receive immunotherapy, even after it stops. Vomiting blood, heavy bleeding, sudden severe abdominal or chest pain, stroke symptoms, seizure, collapse or major breathing difficulty need 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Atezolizumab

- Immune inflammation of lungs, bowel, liver, kidneys or skin
- Hormone changes, including thyroid, adrenal or pituitary problems and diabetes; replacement may be long term
- Rare serious heart, muscle, nerve or brain inflammation
- Infusion/injection reactions; delayed immune effects after stopping

Bevacizumab

- Raised blood pressure; rarely hypertensive crisis or PRES
- Protein in urine and kidney injury, including nephrotic syndrome
- Bleeding, including serious bleeding from varices
- Arterial or venous blood clots
- Poor wound healing, bowel perforation or fistula; rare jaw problems
- Infusion or allergic reactions

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Varices and bleeding

Screening and any required variceal treatment must be reviewed before starting. Call urgently for black stools or blood; vomiting blood or heavy bleeding needs emergency help.

Blood pressure and urine

Blood pressure and urine-protein checks are part of each cycle. Continue prescribed blood-pressure medicines and ask before changing them. A positive urine dipstick may need a timed urine collection.

Immune alert card

Carry the supplied immunotherapy alert card during treatment and afterwards. New symptoms can need urgent treatment; do not wait for routine blood tests.

Support medicines

Both medicines have minimal sickness risk and routine preventive anti-sickness medicines or premedication are not usually required. The team individualises symptom treatment; do not self-treat new significant diarrhoea without advice.

Surgery, dental work and healing

Tell oncology before planned procedures and tell your dentist about bevacizumab. Wounds must heal and the team must agree an interruption/restart plan.

Pregnancy prevention and breastfeeding

Discuss fertility and pregnancy prevention. Atezolizumab requires effective contraception for five months after the last dose and bevacizumab for six months; use the longer interval when both apply. Do not breastfeed during treatment or for at least six months after bevacizumab.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00831/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.